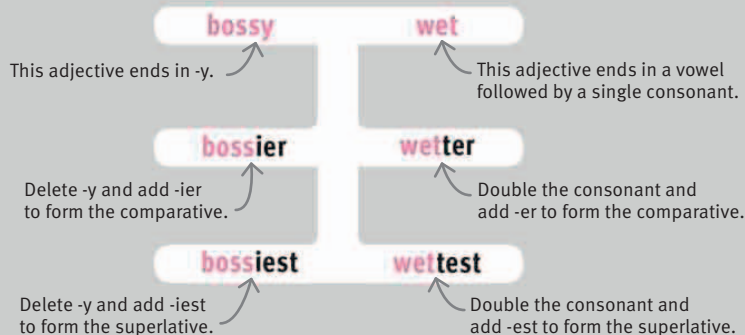




## Identifying irregular adjective spellings

Some adjectives do not follow the rules when it comes to forming their comparatives or superlatives. If an adjective already ends in -e (*rude*), only -r needs to be added to make it comparative (*ruder*), and -st, to make it superlative (*rudest*). Words ending in -y or a vowel and a single consonant have to change their endings.



## Exceptions

Some two-syllable adjectives, such as *lovely*, can take either form of the comparative or superlative (see “Awkward adjectives”). Other adjectives change completely when they are used to compare things. These comparative and superlative forms have to be learned.

| Adjective | Comparative             | Superlative              |
|-----------|-------------------------|--------------------------|
| good      | better                  | best                     |
| bad       | worse                   | worst                    |
| much      | more                    | most                     |
| many      | more                    | most                     |
| little    | less                    | least                    |
| quiet     | quieter or more quiet   | quietest or most quiet   |
| simple    | simpler or more simple  | simplest or most simple  |
| clever    | cleverer or more clever | cleverest or most clever |
| lovely    | lovelier or more lovely | loveliest or most lovely |

carousel, but the roller coaster is train is the **most frightening**.

## Awkward adjectives

If adding the ending -er or -est results in an odd-sounding adjective, the comparative and superlative are formed using the words *more* or *most* before the adjective. This applies to most two-syllable adjectives and all adjectives with three or more syllables.

The ghost train is the **most** frightening.

The superlative *frighteningest* is hard to say, so—because *frightening* has three syllables—the superlative is formed using *most*.

